
Socrates

I find myself in a peculiar predicament, one that requires both clarity of thought and precision in action. The matter at hand involves a significant technological undertaking—one that I would typically approach with measured skepticism.

Yet here I stand, confronted by what appears to be an exercise in circular reasoning. They present us with a solution and ask us to find the problem it solves. Is this not backwards? Should we not first understand the nature of the difficulty before prescribing remedies?

Consider this: A grand institution announces a challenge, yet provides no clear statement of what troubles them. Instead, they insist that whatever solution we propose must incorporate specific technologies—agents, frameworks, and generative models. They speak of “viewing favorably” certain approaches, as if truth itself could be swayed by preference.

What concerns me most is this assumption that complex tools are needed without first examining whether simpler methods might suffice. Have we become so enamored with novelty that we’ve forgotten to ask the fundamental question: Is there truly a problem here that demands such elaborate intervention?

I’m reminded of the ancient principle: The best solution is often the simplest one that adequately addresses the actual need. Yet here, we’re asked to begin with complexity and work backwards to justify it.

Perhaps I’m viewing this too narrowly. Perhaps the challenge itself is an invitation to think differently—to explore the boundaries of what these tools can accomplish rather than what they should accomplish. But even then, shouldn’t we ground our explorations in genuine understanding rather than speculative enthusiasm?

Tell me, what is your perspective on this matter? How should one approach a problem that hasn’t yet been clearly defined?